

BenQ's M555C is a remarkably compact model.

Now, coming to display screens, most of the phones sport a 4,000-colour screen. Nokia 2300, Bird S288 and Philips 9@9++ sport mono-chromatic screens. While Nokia 2300 and Philips 9@9++ use white backlight, the S288 from Bird has a very rich blue backlight. Of all these, the Nokia 2300 gets the nod.

The Sagem phones are next in line, with both the My X-2 and My X-5 sporting 256-colour screens. Though the colour screen offers a slightly better resolution, the colours themselves aren't lively—they lack in depth and saturation. Of course, these 256-colour screens still look way better than monochrome ones.

Amongst the 4,000-colour (4K-colour) screen phones, the Bird S1190 is just a sorry sight—it lacks colour depth and richness. In fact, the model can be mistaken for a 256-colour screen set. Alcatel's Onetouch 535 comes with a large colour screen that makes reading messages not just easy, but a pleasure. The Panasonic EB-G51 and Motorola C350E have decent colour screens,

but the screens are way too small. Sagem's My X-3-2 comes with a 4K-colour screen and is definitely better than the other two Sagem models. The Philips 630, LG 3100 and Siemens A60, all have good colour screens. One practical problem that all these phones have in common, is the fact that they're all quite unreadable in direct sunlight. Siemens models, in particular, draw a lot of flak for this problem.

For colour screens, the top honours go, once again, to the Koreans. The G300 from Pantech with its 270K colour screen makes the screen really come alive with colours that are vibrant and true-to-life. Even though the screen is quite small, the resolution is wonderful, and you can read four lines of text perfectly. With animated menus and sharp colours, these handsets are certainly bound to grab everybody's attention.

Samsung has introduced the 65K-colour screen in two of its models—the SGH-X430 and SGH-S500 have excellent colour screens that are several notches better than lower-end phones in this category.



Panasonic EB-G51	Pantech G300	Philips 630	Philips Xenium 9@9++	Samsung SGH-X430	Samsung SGH-S500	Sagem MY X-2	Sagem MY X-3-2	Sagem MY X-5m	Siemens A60	Sony-Ericsson T230
External	External	External	Internal	External	External	Internal	Internal	Internal	Internal	Internal
78	75	78	93	73	80	89	89	92	85	79
80 x 43 x 19	76 x 40 x 23.5	83 x 43 x 22	108 x 44 x 20	80 x 42 x 20	83 x 43 x 22	99 x 45 x 21	100 x 45 x 21	105 x 46 x 20	110 x 47 x 23	101 x 44 x 19
Dual Band	Dual Band	Dual Band	Dual Band	Dual Band	Dual Band	Dual Band	Dual Band	Dual Band	Tri-band	Dual Band
200	150	200	30 days	260	550	340	340	240	250	275
6	3	2.5	14 days	3.5	5	5	5	4	5	7
4096	256,000	4096	Mono	65,000	65,000	256	4096	256	4096	4096
128 x 128	128 x 128	128 x 128	128 x 128	128 x 128	128 * 160	101 x 80	101 x 80	NA	101 x 80	101 x 80
5	4	5	5	4	4	4	4	3	3	5
Polyphonic	Polyphonic	Polyphonic	Polyphonic	Polyphonic	Polyphonic	Polyphonic	Polyphonic	Polyphonic	Polyphonic	Polyphonic
255	800	300 / 3	500 / 5	500	500	250	500	300	100	250
10 / 10 / 10	10 / 10 / 10	10 / 10 / 10	10 / 10 / 10	10 / 10 / 10	10 / 10 / 10	NA	20 / 20 / 20	10 / 10 / 10	10 / 10 / 10	10 / 10 / 10
Monthly, weekly	Monthly, weekly	Monthly, weekly	Monthly, weekly	Monthly, weekly	Monthly, weekly	None	None	None	None	None
✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	None	None	None	None	✓
✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	None	None	None	None	✓
✓/✗	✓/✗	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✗	✓/✗	✓/✓	✓/✗	✓/✗
✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✗	✓/✗	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✗
✓/✗	✗/✓	✓/✗	✓/✓	✗/✗	✗/✗	✗/✗	✓/✗	✗/✗	✓/✓	✗/✓
✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✗	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✓
✓/2	✓/2	✓/2	✓/2	✓/2	✓/3	✓/2	✓/2	✓/2	✓/2	✓/2
4.5	4	3.5	3	3	3	3.5	3.5	2.5	3	3.75
2.5	3.5	3.25	3.25	3.75	3.75	3	3.5	4	3.5	3.5
2	3	3	3	3.5	3.5	3	3.5	3.5	4	3.75
3	3.5	3.5	3.5	4	4	3.5	3.5	3.5	4	3.25
3	3.5	3.5	3	4	4	3.5	3.5	3.5	4	3.25
61.9	74.86	69.36	65.36	73.91	74.91	54.75	59.3	63.76	71.96	68.21
6990	13995	8890	5320	9649	11499	5199	6199	6699	7000	5495
0.89	0.53	0.78	1.23	0.77	0.65	1.05	0.96	0.95	1.03	1.24
B	C-	A	B-	B+	B	B	B-	C	B+	A